

Why “Allow All” buttons may chill out

Al ethics is the headline, but 2026’s everyday privacy shift is more basic – and more real: India has notified the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules, 2025, operationalising the DPDP Act. In plain terms, companies must tell you the specific purpose for collecting data, keep collection to what’s necessary for that purpose, and maintain reasonable security safeguards. Reporting on the rollout also emphasises user control: clearer notices, meaningful choices (including opt-outs in many cases), and

firmer expectations around breach notifications. The sleeper feature is “Consent Managers”: registered, India-based intermediaries that can help people manage permissions across services, rather than hunting through ten different app settings pages. The Rules are also phased, giving companies time to comply – but the direction is set. For readers, the takeaway is simple: expect more apps to ask for less, explain more, and offer cleaner exits – and start treating “permission hygiene” like password hygiene.



can reduce taps, it reduces friction – and friction is the real enemy of adoption.

The catch? Agentic AI is only lovable when it’s trustworthy. “Doing things for you” is great until it does the wrong thing confidently. So the industry is building more confirmation steps, guardrails, and “are you sure?” moments. It’s less magical, but far safer.

AI reality check: Ethics, privacy, hallucinations and safety

With AI embedded into everything, the uncomfortable stuff becomes impossible to ignore: bias, privacy, manipulation, hallucinations, and the real consequences of people trusting machine output like it’s gospel.

After a string of controversies and public backlash, 2026 is where pressure turns into more rules, more safety features, and more of the “show your

work” expectations. We’re already seeing stronger calls for:

- Guardrails around harmful use cases, especially for vulnerable users
- Clearer transparency when content is AI-generated

- Better provenance – a way to tell what’s real, edited, or synthetic
- Tighter data controls: what gets used, stored, and learned from

In plain English: the AI era is growing up. We still want the benefits – smarter tools, better productivity and more accessible tech – but we also want basic accountability. The wild-west phase of “ship first, apologise later” is getting more expensive politically, legally, and reputationally.

Goodbye passwords, hello passkeys

This is one of the least glamorous but most useful shifts of 2026: the slow death of the password.

Passkeys (device-based logins tied to your fingerprint/face/PIN) are becoming the default way many services want you to sign in. For normal people, the pitch

